AUGUST 2005

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

BARBEQUE & RAFFLE, SUNDAY, 8/7/05 @ 1 PM

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE *BY NICK GALIOTTO*

Can you believe that it's almost August? Well, Craig Holden says his BBQ Committee is all ready for our association's Annual Barbeque and Raffle on Sunday, August 7. This is our biggest event of the year, and Mayor Matt Neely will be dishing up those hamburgers with the assistance of Council members Matt Pear and Mike Kasperzak. Make sure you bring a good appetite to this one!

Wally Erichsen has been joined by Bob Weaver, Barbara Kinchen, John Viscovich, Anne Bakotich, Al Jehning and Vivian Schatz in launching our ad hoc committee regarding the feasibility of establishing a Mountain View History Museum. They are now surveying the eight or nine local museums in nearby cities to learn about their origins and current operations. A mission statement for the committee is also being prepared. If any other members are interested in this committee, Wally says that you're most welcome.

Hip Telmont once again coordinated the MVHA's participation in the recent A la Carte & Art Downtown Festival. Hip and his helpers accounted for the sale of 15 books, signed up three new members, and gave our organization a positive presence at this event. We can use some assistance in setting up a table at the Chamber of Commerce's Art & Wine Festival. Please consider giving Hip a hand during the weekend of September 10 and 11.

Our Executive Committee met on June 1st to plan the association's upcoming activities. This group is so important to our organization, and I personally rely on them to keep things moving forward for the benefit of our members. A very big "thank you" to each of them.

Again, my standard closing: Encourage your friends to attend our meetings. They will learn of Mountain View's colorful past and mingle with some of those that have lived it. That's what we're about. See you on August 7th!!

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 YEARS AGO (1905): **A Farmers and Merchants Bank has just been incorporated and 500 shares of stock, at $100 per share, sold. W. H. Bates, a local contractor, has been awarded a contract for a bank building at the corner of Castro and Villa Streets, to be built of San Jose sandstone.**

Father Cullen presided at the cornerstone-laying ceremony at the site of the new St. Joseph's Catholic Church at Hope and Church Streets. A large tent was erected on Castro Street where members and visitors were served both lunch and supper.

Spicer and Mesa started an ice business. The ice, made from pure distilled water, came from Sacramento. Residents had to depend in the past on an ice wagon from San Jose.

Miss Jessie Lovejoy won the Goddess of Liberty contest. Her attendants at the Fourth of July parade were May Dunsford and Annie Campen.

75 YEARS AGO (1930)**: July prices at Mountain View's Blue and White Stores:**

Butter @ 42 cents a pound.....Watermelon @ 2 cents per pound
Sugar @ 45 cents for ten pounds.....Local tomatoes @ 17 cents for 3 pounds

"The most innovative café on the Peninsula," the Bird Cage, opened on El Camino, just south of D&S Lumber. Mr. A. Clark, proprietor, has dozens of singing canaries, bright colored parrots and many other valuable birds to entertain his customers.

A daytime fire burned a number of cabins on the Gallimore ranch, near South Shore Port, occupied by Filipino cannery workers. There was one death of a man who had been ill and remained home from work. Recently, there had been letters threatening to destroy any property housing Filipinos.

Federal agents arrested Battista Bordi at his Stevens Creek ranch for possessing more wine than he was supposed to have. Over 3,800 gallons were seized. It was later returned and charges dismissed because of a faulty warrant.

An audience of Japanese enjoyed a movie in Swall's Hall until the film caught fire. According to regulations, a fireman was stationed in the hall that night, Ed Demezze, and everyone was escorted out with no injuries.

50 YEARS AGO (1955): **Disneyland opened in Anaheim and five of the rides had been made by Arrow Development Company, 243 Moffett Boulevard, Mountain View.**

A new business office for Pacific Telegraph and Telephone was constructed at 707 California Street, at the corner of Hope and California. James Gard was manager.

Trustees of the Mountain View Elementary School District condemned the 27-year old Highway Grammar School. A detailed structural survey showed it was not up to State regulations for safety.

Nine hundred students attended that school and will have to be accommodated in other schools, possibly by running double sessions.

George Sohler, long associated with the City of Mountain View, retired. Over a period of nearly 30 years, he served ten years on the city council, two terms as mayor, superintendent of water works, building inspector and part-time engineering inspector.

25 YEARS AGO (1980): Senator Alan Cranston was present for the dedication of Monte Vista Terrace, the new $5.8 Million housing development on Grant Road, former site of Monte Vista Drive In Theatre. One hundred eighty low income seniors and handicapped residents moved in and there is a long waiting list for future openings.

While other libraries are cutting back hours because of funding problems, Mountain View added one additional hour of service. Library hours are 10 to 9 Monday through Thursday, 10 to 6 Friday and Saturday and 2 to 5 on Sunday.

Awalt High School's Jazz Ensemble and the Reflections, jazz vocalists, traveled to Mexico and for one week performed in Mexico City and at the University of Mexico. Raffles and car washes helped raise the $500 for each of the performers, aides and chaperones, 34 total making the trip.

Plans were approved for James and Francine Dale to reconstruct Cherry Chase Golf Course and to construct seven three-story buildings for condominiums around the greens.

Dominating the news all summer were stories of deadlocked negotiations over salary and pension demands by fire and police personnel. Pickets were placed at City Hall and firefighters went on strike for 39 days. All but one fire station was closed and out-of-town firemen hired. Special security measures went into effect for city buildings and city officials. Threatened with the loss of jobs, firemen went back to work the first week in September. Police did not strike, but held a one day "blue flu" sickout in support of firemen and signed a contract in August. Salaries were increased but neither firemen nor police gained the pension packages they had demanded.

STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN

Aitken Avenue, a very short street running off Solana Drive in the area west of El Monte, is named for Malcolm "Max" Aitken, long-time chemistry teacher at the Castro Street Mountain View High School.

NEW QUESTION

What street is named for one of Mountain View's early Baptist ministers?

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORY CENTER

From member Dorothy DeDontney: **A 78 page booklet, "Mountain View's Woman's Club One Hundred Years of History, 1904-2004," compiled by Dorothy.**

From Carl Bordi: **Cigarette lighter inscribed Town Club**
Geo
Al
Fred
180 Castro Street
Mt. View

From Anthony Salko: **"The Ranch – 313 South Bernardo, Mountain View, CA," written in 2001 by Mr. Salko about his family and their activities growing up on that property.**

From Carol Rudgers: **Eleven Mountain View High School yearbooks, era 1910-1920, and eleven photos, including the Schmidt Junction Garage on El Camino Real and the Vincent home on Calderon Avenue. Carol is the daughter of Carl Schmidt and Bernice Vincent Schmidt.**

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE REPORT

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on June 1, 2005. Membership and book sales resulting from the A la Carte & Art Festival were discussed as well as new donations to the History Room. Discussion of the upcoming BBQ and Raffle and assignments were held as well as the new committee formed to research a larger History Center or possible History Museum of our own.

JUST IN CASE YOU LOST THE EARLIER BBQ ORDER FORM…

Barbecue Order Form

Send This Form With Your Check to:
MVHA Barbecue
107 Del Monte
Los Altos, CA 94022

Your Name and Phone:_____

Names of Guests:_____

Number of Adults _____ @ $ 10.00 = $ _____
Number of Children _____ @ $ 5.00 = $ _____

Total Amount Enclosed $ _____

Please Mail By:
July 23, 2005
Thank You

MEMORIES OF LIVING IN MOUNTAIN VIEW

BY MEMBER LORRAINE (SIEBERT) MARTIN

While my family was not a pioneer family, it is hard to believe it was 60 years ago that we settled in Mountain View. My older sister and parents relocated to Mountain View from Illinois when they decided to stay after a visit.

I arrived at the end of the semester in my freshman year of high school and graduated from Mountain View Union High School in 1948. The war was still on but my parents decided to build their own home on the corner of Mariposa and Latham, which was outside the city limits. Building materials were nearly impossible to obtain, so they bought an army barracks on Page Mill Road near where HP now stands. They took it apart board by board, window by window. While they built our home, we stayed in the old Mountain View Hotel in the first block from the railroad tracks on Castro Street. The hotel was above the first Chinese restaurant and we would fall asleep listening to Chinese music. The home was completed sometime in late 1945.

I have many pleasant memories of MVUHS. Stan and Edna Thompson worked there at that time as did Eva (Monk) Mockbee. Mr. and Mrs. Blalock both were teachers there and later became my cousin's in-laws. Mr. Blalock steered me in the direction of higher math which qualified me for breaking into a computer career. Miss Froehlich taught chorus which I became very active in. Very pleasant memories.

Another activity was organizing a Girl Scout Mariner Troup. We had many dances with the Mountain View Sea Scouts who had their boats at the Palo Alto Harbor. The Sea Scouts were sponsored by the Mountain View fire department, which were all volunteers at that time. The Scouts were active volunteers also. I have pictures of them helping dedicate the "new" post office which had moved from Castro Street to Dana.

During lunch hour on Wednesdays, my friend June Andrews and I would go across the street to the hall on the corner to serve lunch to the Kiwanians. Bay Hayes (the local mortician) was the Secretary/Treasurer and he paid us $0.50 per luncheon, a free meal and we were able to skip PE class. Mrs. Peracchi, whose son ran the grocery store "Food City," was the Cook. Mr. Cooke, our high school principal was also a Kiwanis member.

What a wonderful place to live. The towns in the area were separated by orchards and the local teens could always get jobs picking prunes or slicing apricots. I remember one September when the opening of school was delayed because the prunes were still to be picked. Across the street from our house, I used to work in the flower beds at $0.25 per hour.

I lived in the Bay Area until 1989 and have been a member of the MVHA for a number of years.

EDITOR'S NOTE: Many thanks to Lorraine for her article. We are looking for additional stories. They should be about one to two pages in length and submitted with the understanding that, with your submittal, you are permitting "editing" where necessary. You may also email copy to me at trudi@tubanonline.org.

IN MEMORIAM

***DOROTHY POXON DIXON** passed away in a rest home in Oregon recently. She attended the Mountain View Union High School in the 1940s. She is survived by a sister, Margaret Barre, of Palo Alto. Dorothy was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.*

***EMMA TRAVERSO LUIS** passed away on April 19, 2005. She was born on March 18, 1918 in Mountain View and lived there all her life. She was predeceased by her husband Manuel and is survived by her son Gary and his wife Caryl and daughter Lisa Ostrowski and her husband Mark.*

Emma attended local schools and graduated from the Mountain View Union High School in 1939. She was a long time member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $100 per person.

Life Members	115	
Honored Member	1	
Family Membership	128	
Single Membership	102	
TOTAL		346

New Members: Helen Huges, Laura J. Babcock, C. W. Hobbs, Stephen Carney and Matt Neely.

New Life Members: Louis Beck and Glenn E. Wilson

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

President	Nick Galiotto
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	John Viscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President	Craig Holden
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Programs & Publicity	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Dorothy Rich
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT
JUNE 30, 2005

Ending Balance as of March 23, 2005.....$33,419.64

INCOME:

3/31	Deposit/Interest March	$	53.86
4/7	Deposit	$	360.27
	Membership	$138.00	
	Books/Taxable	$ 32.42	
	Books/Nontaxable	$149.85	
	Booklets	$ 40.00	
4/29	Deposit/Interest April	$	54.44
5/31	Deposit/Interest May	$	60.98
6/13	Deposit	$1,212.85	
	Books/Taxable	$ 505.42	
	Books/Nontaxable	$ 377.43	
	Membership	$ 330.00	

EXPENSE:

3/29	#256	Margaret Peterson	$ 22.20
3/29	#257	Craig Holden	$ 18.29
3/29	#258	City of Mtn View (Insurance)	$ 181.80
6/5	#259	CBA/Booth Rental	$ 100.00
6/12	#260	Trudi Tuban	$ 139.01

#261-#300 Checks not in Treasurer's Book

6/12	#301	Secretaryof State Filing Fee	$ 20.00
6/12	#302	VTF Services	$ 161.40
6/12	#303	Hip Telmont – Table & Chairs	$ 107.15
6/30	#304	Eugene Sharp/Office Supplies	$ 65.60
6/30	#305	Margaret Peterson	$ 39.21

ENDING BALANCE AS OF JUNE 30, 2005.....$34,307.38

Mountain View Historical Association

BARBEQUE & RAFFLE

Sunday, August 7, 2005
1 PM

The Adobe Building at Moffett Boulevard and Central Expressway

MEMBERSHIP: *Any person who signifies interest in th Aims of this Association and who pays the specified dues May become a member of this Association.*

AIMS: *The aims of this Association are: to gather and Preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View, to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our organization.*

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION:

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

Telephone: _____

Type Membership: NEW _____ RENEWAL _____

____ Regular Membership, $7.00/year
____ Family Membership, $10/year
____ Life Member, $100.00

Please make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View CA 94042

The Adobe Building
Moffett Blvd and
Central Express Way

MOUNTAIN VIEW JUL 21 '05 CA PB METER 8350491 ≈ 0.37 ≈ U.S. POSTAGE

Mountain View
Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042



2006

first class mail